Lantern Compose

An offline writing suite inside Lantern Office Suite · v1.7.0 · 19 October 2026

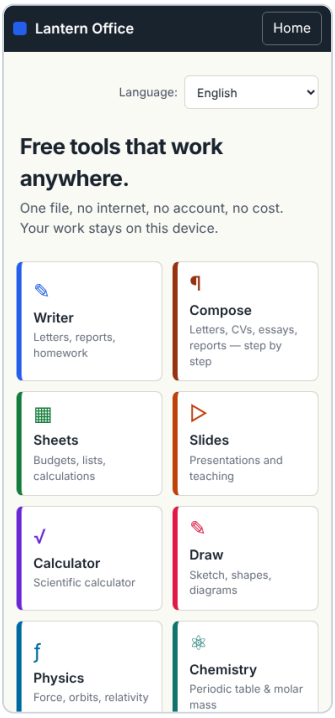
Lantern already let people *type* documents. Compose is for **writing** them: the letters, CVs, essays, reports, notices and forms that decide whether someone gets a job, a repair, a school place or a grant. It guides the writer one part at a time, checks the result, explains the rules in plain language, and gives practice. It runs entirely on the device, in the same single file, with no internet, account or cost.

18 guided writing tasks	**30** Writer templates (26 new)	**18** short writing lessons	**60** practice prompts, 3 levels
412 common misspellings fixed	**39** grammar & confused-word rules	**189** thesaurus headwords	**50** flashcards in 3 writing decks

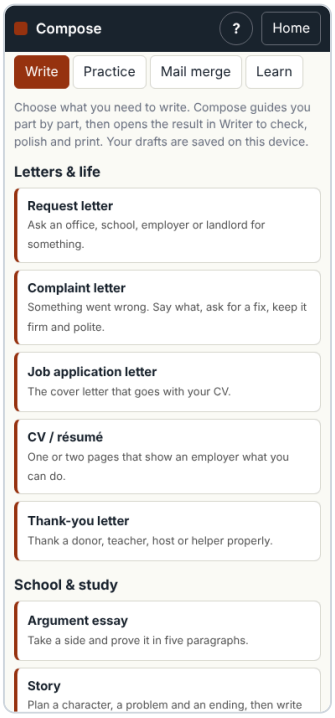
Why it is built this way

- **Offline and shareable.** One 1.35 MB HTML file. Copy it by USB stick, SD card, Bluetooth or a messaging app; it opens in any phone or computer browser. Nothing is sent anywhere.
- **Phone first.** Every screen was checked in a real browser at phone size (390 px wide) and desktop size.
- **Drafts survive.** Answers save on the device as they are typed, so a locked phone or a flat battery loses nothing.
- **Teaches as it corrects.** Every checker suggestion has a *Why?* button that opens the matching lesson.
- **Plain language.** Readers with less schooling are the audience the checker aims for: the live reading level encourages grade 6–8 for letters and notices. The examples use everyday settings (savings groups, clinics, landlords, schools, market stalls).
- **Never rewrites behind your back.** *Fix all safe* only applies certain corrections (spelling, *should of*, double words, capitals). Style hints are left for the writer to decide.

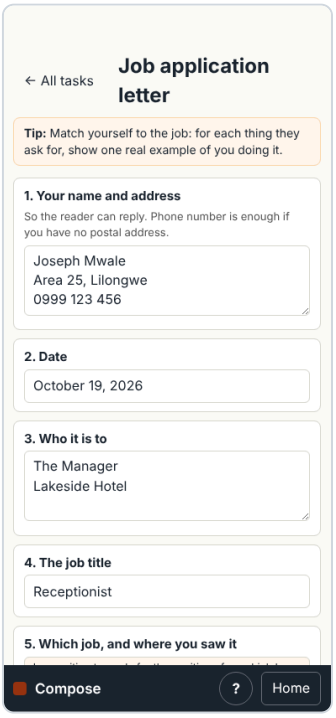
Compose: the four tabs



Compose sits next to Writer on the home screen



Write: choose a task



One part at a time, with a tip and help



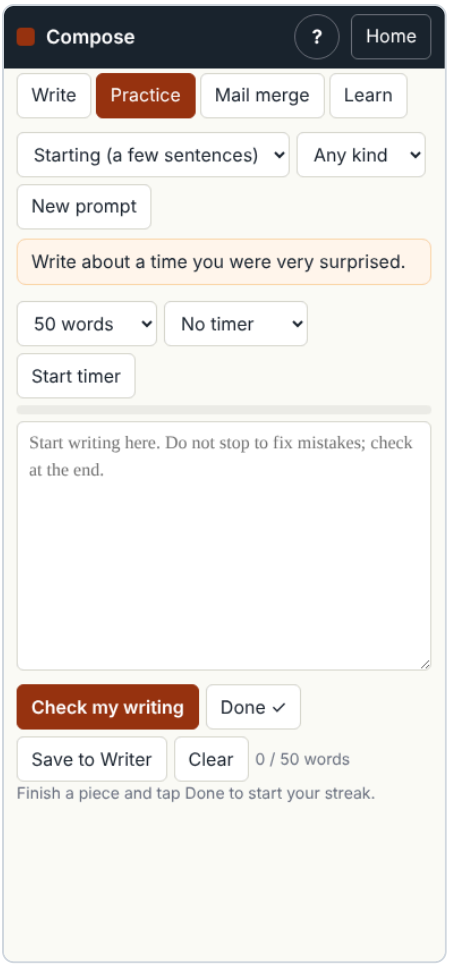
Preview with reading level, then Open in Writer

Write

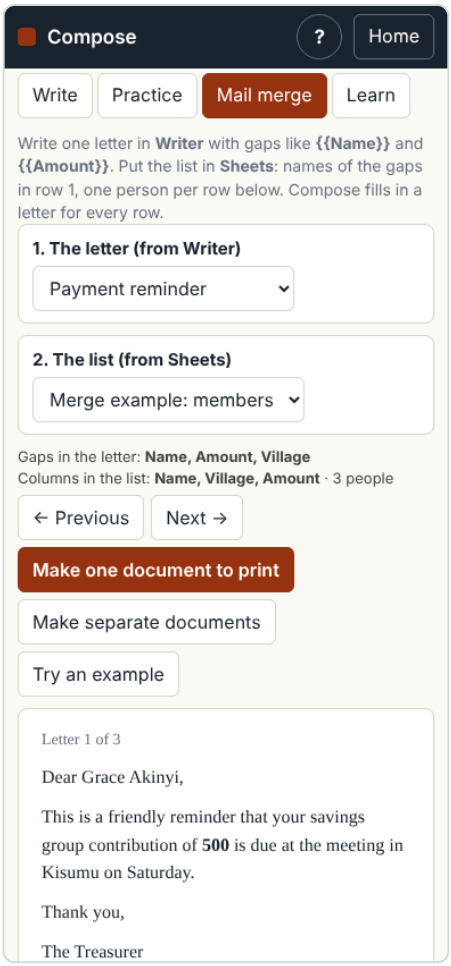
Eighteen guided tasks in three groups:

Letters & life	Request letter, complaint letter, job application letter, CV / résumé, thank-you letter
School & study	Argument essay, story, summary, report (science or field), description, speech, personal statement
Work & community	Community notice, short message (SMS / chat, with a 160-character counter), meeting minutes, project / funding proposal, incident report, news story

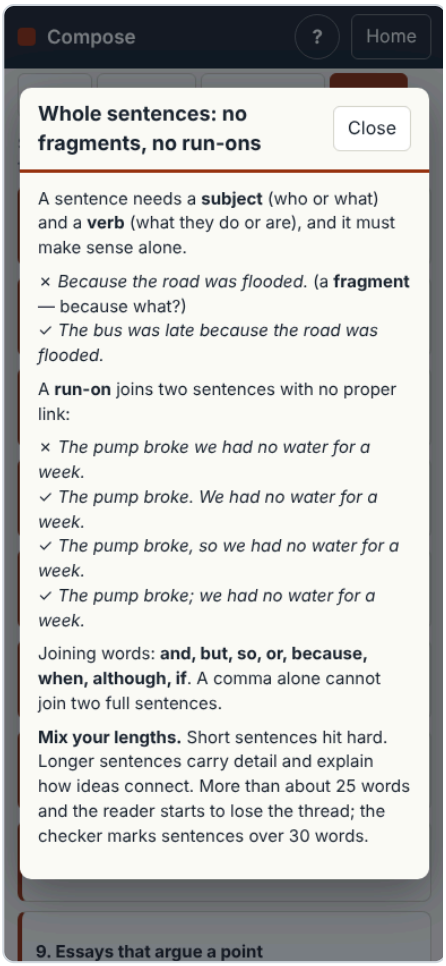
Each task opens with a tip that says what the reader will look for. Each part explains what belongs there and offers **sentence starters**: tap one and the cursor lands in its first gap; later gaps stay marked “...” and the counter shows how many are still to fill. **Preview** assembles the finished piece (addresses, date, bold subject line, greeting, sign-off) and shows its reading level and how many suggestions the checker has. **Open in Writer** creates the document there, ready to check, print or save as PDF.



Practice: prompt, word goal, timer, streak



Mail merge: one letter, many people



Learn: 18 lessons, opened from the checker too

Practice

Sixty prompts at three levels (Starting, Growing, Confident) and six kinds (describe, story, explain, persuade, letter, reflect). Set a word goal and an optional timer, write without stopping, then **Check my writing**. **Done** counts the day toward a practice streak; **Save to Writer** keeps the piece.

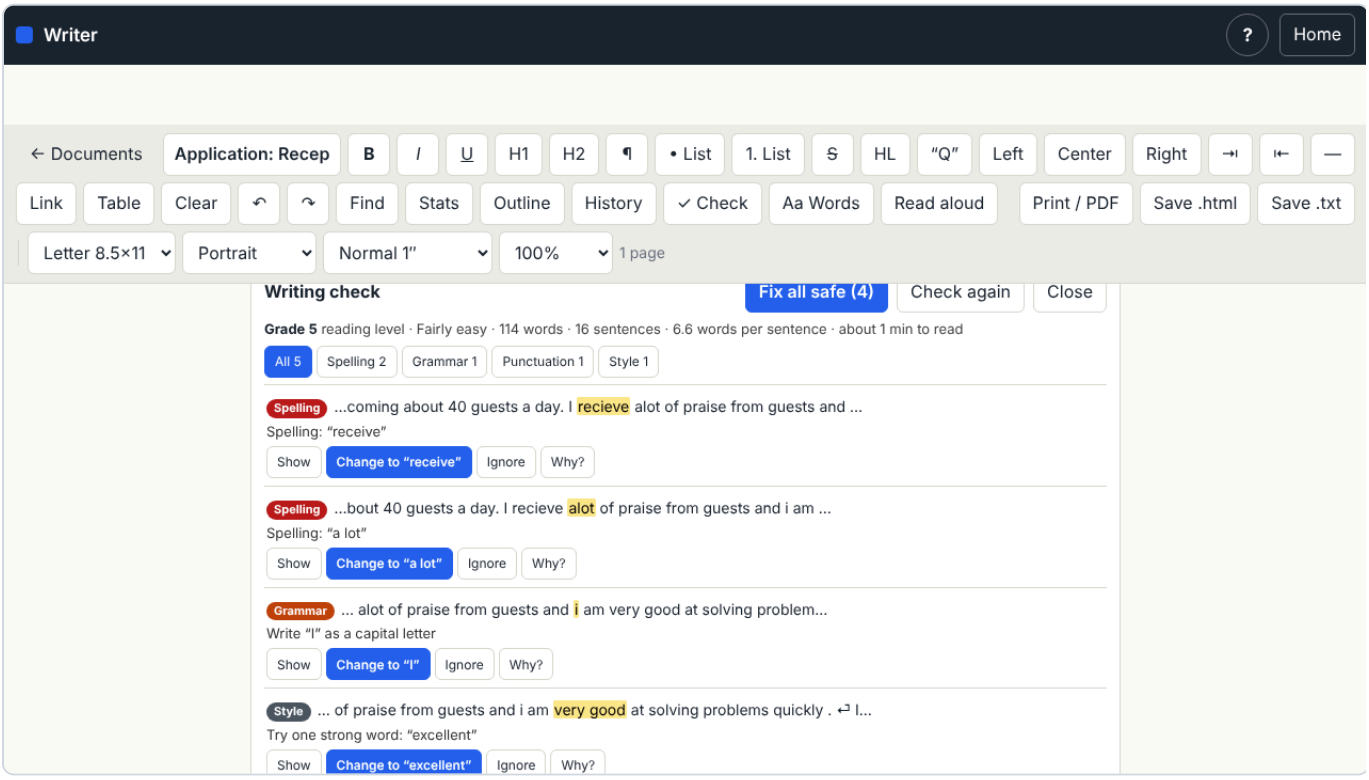
Mail merge

Write one letter in Writer with gaps such as `{{Name}}` and `{{Amount}}`; put the same names in row 1 of a Sheets list, one person per row. Compose checks that every gap has a column, previews each letter, and makes one printable document (each letter on its own page) or separate documents. **Try an example** builds a savings-group reminder so the idea is clear in seconds. Useful for schools, clinics, cooperatives and churches.

Learn

Eighteen short lessons: the writing process, sentences, punctuation, grammar, paragraphs, plain language, word choice, editing, essays, persuasion, stories, summaries, reports, letters, CVs, forms and officials, confused words, and spelling. The **Cards** app adds three writing decks: tricky spellings, confused words and punctuation.

New in Writer



✓ Check

The writing checker groups suggestions as Spelling, Grammar, Punctuation and Style, each with **Show**, **Change to** (when there is a sure fix), **Ignore** and **Why?**. It catches common misspellings (*recieve, alot, untill*), confused words and slips (*should of, your welcome, a apple, bigger then, less people*), doubled words, lower-case *i*, missing capitals and full stops, spacing, unclosed brackets and quotes, long sentences, wordy phrases (*in order to*), *very* + weak word, and possible passive voice. Headings, list items, bold subject lines and dialogue (*"Run!" shouted Ama.*) are not flagged. A line above the page shows the reading level live as you type; tap *hide* to turn it off.

Aa Words

Select a word and tap a replacement. Choices come back in the same form as the selected word (*walked → strolled*, *running → sprinting*, *quickly → rapidly*, *things → objects*), so a swap never breaks the grammar; every choice offered for 845 test words is a real dictionary word. With nothing selected it lists your most-used words.

Read aloud

Reads the document sentence by sentence with highlighting, using the voices built into the device. Choose speed and voice. Hearing a draft is the best proofreading there is, and it helps readers who are still learning.

Templates

26 new templates (30 in all), including complaint, request, landlord repairs, permission, authorisation, reference, thank-you, absence note, resignation, apology, incident report, project proposal, funding request, business plan, agenda, invitation, petition, news story, essay, story planner, book report, speech, science report, summary and personal statement.

Honest limits

- **The checker is for English.** Compose's menus and labels are translated into the eight languages Lantern already ships (Filipino, Spanish, French, Portuguese, Swahili, Hindi, Indonesian, Chinese); the tasks, lessons and checker content are English. Templates and mail merge work in any language.
- **It is a pattern checker, not a grammar engine.** It is tuned to raise few false alarms on correct writing, so it will miss some mistakes. It is a second pair of eyes, not a replacement for reading the work aloud.
- **Voices depend on the device.** Read aloud uses whatever speech voices the phone or computer has installed; some older phones have none.
- **Writer on a small phone.** Writer shows real paper (Letter / A4) at full size, which is wider than a phone. While drafting on a phone, choose **Continuous** in Writer's paper menu, then switch to A4 or Letter before printing. The Compose help says this too.

For maintainers

Thirty-two new modules (188 → 220), each under the 1,500-word size gate, ES5–ES2017 only, ASCII source. Every one can be removed on its own and the rest of the suite still boots and runs (rule 11); the self-tests each module registers only appear when the modules they need are present, so removing one never blocks the Forge gate.

Engine	COMPOSE_TEXT (words, sentences, syllables, Flesch ease, Flesch–Kincaid grade), COMPOSE_RULES, COMPOSE_RULES_USAGE, COMPOSE_SPELL, COMPOSE_CHECK, COMPOSE_CHECK_STYLE, COMPOSE_THESAURUS, COMPOSE_INFLECT, COMPOSE_THESAURUS_B, COMPOSE_DOM
Writer tools	WRITER_CHECK, WRITER_WORDS, WRITER_SPEAK, WRITER_TEMPLATES_LETTERS / _WORK / _STUDY
Compose app	COMPOSE_TASKS_LIFE / _STUDY / _WORK, COMPOSE_KIT, COMPOSE_APP, COMPOSE_PROMPTS, COMPOSE_PRACTICE, COMPOSE_MERGE
Teaching & help	COMPOSE_LESSONS_BASICS / _STYLE / _FORMS / _LIFE, CARDS_STARTERS_WRITING, GUIDE_COMPOSE, LOCALE_COMPOSE, COMPOSE_SELFTEST
Host hooks (rule 10)	`Lantern.writerDocs` {list, get, create, open}, `Lantern.sheetDocs` {list, values, create}, `Lantern.composeTasks`, `Lantern.composeTabs`, `Lantern.composeLessonOrder`, `Lantern.compose.checkers`

Extending it: a new task is a data entry pushed to `Lantern.composeTasks` (steps with label, help and starters, plus an output layout); a new checker rule is a function pushed to `Lantern.compose.checkers`; a new Compose tab is pushed to `Lantern.composeTabs`. None of these need edits to existing modules.

Tests: `npm test` runs 13 checks, all passing: the 10 existing suite checks plus Compose engine (81 assertions, including correct sentences that must raise no alarms), Compose app end to end (47), and per-module isolation for all 32 modules. The suite was also driven in real Chromium at phone and desktop sizes: 42 apps on the home screen, a full job letter written, checked and fixed, no page errors.